

Your amazing body

CELLS

★ The body's biggest cells—female egg cells—are $\frac{1}{1000}$ in **(0.1 mm)** across and visible to the naked eye.

★ Lined up in a row, **40 average-sized cells** would stretch across a period.

★ **300 million body cells** die and are replaced every minute.

★ Liver cells last for about **18 months**.

★ Red blood cells can last for up to **120 days**.

★ Small intestine cells last for just **36 hours** before they are worn away by the passage of food.

SKIN, NAILS, AND HAIR

• The outer layer of the skin, the upper epidermis, is replaced **every month**.

• About **50,000 skin flakes** drop off the skin's surface every minute. That amounts to about 40 lb (20 kg) of skin flakes in a lifetime, which is about the weight of a young child.

• Skin varies in thickness, from $\frac{2}{100}$ in **(0.5 mm)** on the eyelids to $\frac{1}{4}$ in (6 mm) on the soles of the feet.

• The skin is the body's heaviest organ, weighing about **11 lb (5 kg)** in an adult.

• Skin color depends on the amount of pigment or **melanin** that the skin produces. Small amounts of melanin result in light skin, while large amounts result in dark skin.

• Each human being has around **2.5 million sweat pores**. Sweat empties through the pores onto the skin's surface.

• Fingernails **grow four times faster** than toenails, and faster in summer than in winter.

• **About 120 head hairs** (out of 100,000 in total) are lost and replaced daily.

• Head hair normally grows $\frac{1}{2}$ in **(12 mm)** a month. It usually stops growing when it is 2 ft (60 cm) long, falls out, and is replaced. Some people, however, can grow their hair to 13 ft (4 m) long.

• Nearly everyone has **eyelash mites** (harmless, sausage-shaped animals) that live in the hair follicles of humans.